France 2026 Wealth and Tax Primer

A current official-source orientation to income tax, micro-enterprise, investment wrappers, records and adviser questions.

MATRIX REPROGRAMMED - DETAILED WEALTH GUIDE

Reader outcome: Build a France-specific fact file and identify which decisions require current professional advice.

Best for: A France-based reader preparing tax, business and investment questions for 2026.

Edition checked: 2026-08-01

Educational information only. No personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice. No guaranteed outcomes.

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1. France 2026 boundary

This primer is an orientation to official research routes, not a personal tax calculation.

Tax depends on household composition, income type, residence, ownership, business form, dates and elections.

Use the official 2026 position and retain a dated copy or reference.

Do not rely on a threshold without confirming which income year, filing year and activity it applies to.

2. Income-tax framework

French income tax uses progressive bands and household quotient rules subject to current law and individual facts.

Identify salary, pension, business, property, investment and exceptional income separately.

Record withholding and prepayments but reconcile them with final liability.

Use BOFiP and impots.gouv.fr for the current bands and treatment, then confirm personal application.

3. Micro-enterprise 2026 turnover thresholds

Official 2026 guidance states a EUR 203,100 annual turnover ceiling for qualifying sales activities.

Official 2026 guidance states a EUR 83,600 annual turnover ceiling for qualifying services and relevant accommodation activities.

For mixed activity, total turnover and the services sub-limit must both be monitored.

Thresholds may be prorated for a partial year and differ from VAT thresholds.

Turnover is not profit; the micro regime generally uses standard allowances rather than actual-cost deduction.

4. Micro social contributions and declarations

The micro-social system calculates contributions as a percentage of declared turnover under the applicable activity rate.

Declarations are required on the chosen schedule, including zero-turnover periods where required.

Classify the activity correctly because rates and tax categories can differ.

Maintain invoices, turnover records and bank evidence even under a simplified regime.

Compare micro simplicity with actual costs and future growth before assuming it is optimal.

5. Individual business and company choices

Compare EI, micro, EURL, SARL, SASU and SAS using liability, partners, social protection, tax, payroll, dividends, finance and administration.

5. Individual business and company choices (continued)

A company is not automatically more tax efficient and may increase annual cost.
Use the official business formalities portal for registrations and changes.
Model how cash reaches the owner and what remains available to the business.
Obtain advice before restructuring an existing profitable activity.

6. VAT

VAT thresholds and rules are separate from micro-enterprise turnover eligibility.
Check current thresholds, activity, customer location and place-of-supply rules.
Collected VAT is not business revenue.
Cross-border goods, digital services, imports and mixed activities require extra care.
Invoice wording and records must match the applicable status.

7. PEA

The PEA is a French investment wrapper with eligibility, contribution, asset and withdrawal rules.
Tax treatment depends on the age of the plan and the nature of withdrawal under current law.
Compare product fees, underlying assets, diversification and access restrictions.
A PEA tax benefit does not remove market risk or make every eligible security suitable.

8. Assurance-vie

Assurance-vie combines an insurance contract wrapper, investment options, beneficiary terms, fees and tax rules.
Treatment can depend on contract age, payment dates, premium amounts and withdrawal composition.
Compare entry, management, fund, arbitration and guarantee costs.
Review beneficiary wording and estate consequences with appropriate advice.
Do not confuse the insurer guarantee framework with a guarantee of investment performance.

9. Investment income and PFU questions

Investment income and gains may be subject to flat-rate or progressive treatment depending on current rules and elections.
An election may apply broadly rather than to one isolated item; confirm before choosing.
Social-contribution rates and exceptions can change and may differ by product.
Record acquisition cost, fees, distributions, disposals and foreign withholding.

10. Property, wealth and succession questions

Property income, capital gains, local taxes, financing and wealth-tax exposure require asset-specific facts.

10. Property, wealth and succession questions (continued)

IFI and exemption questions depend on net taxable real-estate assets, debt and professional-use rules.
Succession and gifts depend on relationship, allowances, ownership rights, prior gifts and timing.
Use a notaire or specialist adviser where property ownership, family transfer or estate planning is material.

11. France annual file

[ ] Household and residence facts.
[ ] Income by category.
[ ] Withholding and prepayments.
[ ] Business turnover and activity classification.
[ ] VAT position.
[ ] Investment statements and acquisition costs.
[ ] Property income, debt and works.
[ ] Pension and insurance contributions.
[ ] Gifts, succession and beneficiary changes.
[ ] Foreign accounts, income or assets.
[ ] Official sources checked with date.
[ ] Professional questions and written answers.

12. How to use this guide

Purpose: Build a France-specific fact file and identify which decisions require current professional advice.
Best reader: A France-based reader preparing tax, business and investment questions for 2026.
Read the guide once without taking action. On the second pass, complete the checklists and write down the evidence supporting each decision.
Replace every example number with your own verified amount, date, fee, tax treatment, contract term or source document.
Do not treat a checklist tick as proof. Keep copies of the underlying statements, quotations, filings, contracts and calculations.
For major decisions, use this guide to prepare better questions for a regulated adviser, accountant, lawyer, lender or insurer.

13. Evidence standard

Tier 1: law, regulator, tax authority, court, audited accounts, official product document or signed contract.
Tier 2: recognised institutional research that states its methodology, date and limitations.
Tier 3: reputable reporting used to identify questions, not to replace primary evidence.

13. Evidence standard (continued)

Tier 4: marketing, social posts, testimonials, screenshots and anonymous claims. Treat these as unverified leads.
Write the source date beside every changing figure. A correct figure without a date can become misleading.
Separate facts, estimates, assumptions and scenarios. Never allow a scenario to be presented as a forecast or guarantee.
A company, fund, adviser, trust, structure, transaction or association is not proof of misconduct.

14. Decision record worksheet

[ ] State the decision in one sentence.
[ ] State the desired result and deadline.
[ ] List the three strongest pieces of supporting evidence.
[ ] List the three strongest reasons the decision may fail.
[ ] Record the maximum acceptable loss of money, time and flexibility.
[ ] Record the smallest reversible test.
[ ] Name the person responsible for checking legal, tax or regulatory consequences.
[ ] Set the next review date and the evidence that would cause you to stop.

15. Professional advice triggers

Seek regulated investment advice when product suitability, risk capacity, pensions, insurance or a large portfolio decision is unclear.
Seek tax advice before changing residence, extracting company cash, transferring assets, using trusts, gifting substantial sums or entering cross-border arrangements.
Seek legal advice before signing guarantees, shareholder agreements, acquisition contracts, complex leases, loan security or beneficiary arrangements.
Seek accounting advice when turnover, VAT, payroll, inventory, multiple activities or company-group transactions become material.
Use a defined written question. Paying for broad reassurance without documents or calculations rarely produces a useful answer.

16. Subject focus map

Use the following subject anchors as named checkpoints. For each checkpoint, record the fact, source, date, assumption, decision and next review date.
FRANCE 2026: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.
203,100: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.
83,600: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.

16. Subject focus map (continued)

PEA: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.
ASSURANCE-VIE: define what this checkpoint means for this guide, what evidence supports it, and what result would cause you to change course.
Do not mark a checkpoint complete because an action was taken. Mark it complete only when the result and supporting evidence have been recorded.
Where a checkpoint depends on another person, institution, platform or contract, record that dependency and a fallback route.
Rank checkpoints by potential harm if ignored, not by how interesting or easy they appear.
At the end of each review, choose one checkpoint to advance and one risk to reduce before adding a new objective.

17. Worked decision case

Write a real decision from your own situation at the top of a blank page. Examples include changing work, launching an offer, choosing an account, buying an asset, restructuring a business or rejecting a proposal.
Baseline: state the current cash, income, liabilities, commitments, ownership, legal position and time available. Use documents rather than memory where possible.
Desired result: describe the measurable outcome, deadline and reason. Remove vague language such as more, better, passive, safe or guaranteed.
Options: include the proposed action, a smaller reversible test, a diversified alternative, delaying the action and doing nothing.
Evidence: attach at least three independent sources. Identify which evidence is official, contractual, audited, estimated, promotional or missing.
Economics: show setup cost, recurring cost, cash timing, fees, tax reserve, downside loss, opportunity cost and the point at which the decision becomes worthwhile.
Risk: identify concentration, liquidity, legal, operational, fraud, health, relationship and behavioural risks. Name the risk that could create irreversible harm.
Professional review: write the exact question that requires an accountant, lawyer, regulated adviser, lender, insurer or technical specialist.
Decision: state proceed, test, delay or reject. Record the maximum commitment and the evidence required before any further commitment.
Review: set a dated checkpoint. Write the result that would confirm the decision, the result that would require adjustment and the result that would trigger an immediate stop.

18. 90-day implementation workbook

Week 1 - Establish the baseline. Reconcile the relevant accounts, contracts, statements, fees, tax records, responsibilities and deadlines.
Week 2 - Define the result. Choose one measurable outcome and remove actions that do not directly support it or protect an essential risk.

18. 90-day implementation workbook (continued)

Week 3 - Gather primary evidence. Use official registers, filings, signed terms, current quotations and dated institutional data.
Week 4 - Compare alternatives. Include a lower-cost option, a lower-risk option, a reversible test and the option to wait.
Week 5 - Model the economics. Build downside, base and upside cases while treating every uncertain input as an assumption.
Week 6 - Verify identity and authority. Confirm who owns, controls, advises, holds money, signs contracts and bears liability.
Week 7 - Run the smallest useful test. Limit money, time and legal commitment while collecting evidence about real demand or performance.
Week 8 - Reconcile actual results. Compare promised, expected and actual cost, time, cash flow, quality, risk and customer or counterparty behaviour.
Week 9 - Repair the constraint. Improve the single factor currently limiting income, retention, safety, liquidity, delivery or evidence quality.
Week 10 - Install controls. Add calendar reminders, approval limits, account separation, written procedures, backups and review ownership.
Week 11 - Decide whether to scale. Increase commitment only when the test produced measurable value and the downside remains affordable.
Week 12 - Complete the evidence file. Store the decision record, sources, calculations, contracts, results, lessons and next review date.
Day 90 - Write a one-page conclusion: what was established, what remains uncertain, what changed, what will continue and what will stop.

19. Review, escalation and stop rules

Review monthly when the decision affects recurring cash, debt, customer commitments, investment contributions or essential protection.
Review immediately after a material legal change, tax notice, contract change, security incident, missed payment, large loss, health event or relationship change.
Escalate to a qualified professional when the facts cross jurisdictions, involve regulated products, create personal guarantees, affect beneficiaries or cannot be reversed cheaply.
Pause when required documents are missing, identities cannot be independently verified, costs are unclear or the counterparty resists reasonable due diligence.
Stop when the action requires deception, undeclared income, false invoices, hidden beneficial ownership, unaffordable leverage or essential-living money.
Stop when actual cash use, delivery time or loss exceeds the written limit.
Stop when the central evidence is corrected, withdrawn, contradicted by a stronger source or no longer current.
Do not move a stop limit merely because money, pride or time has already been committed. Sunk cost is not evidence that continuing is rational.
Record every exception to the plan, who approved it and why. Repeated exceptions indicate the plan or control is not working.
A stopped action can still be a successful decision when it prevents a larger loss

19. Review, escalation and stop rules (continued)

and preserves the ability to act later.

20. Evidence and legal boundary

This is educational information, not personalised financial, investment, legal, accounting or tax advice.
Investments can fall in value. Businesses can fail. Debt, leverage, illiquidity, tax and legal obligations can create losses greater than the expected benefit.
Rules and thresholds change. Verify the current official position on the date of action.
Never use false invoices, hidden ownership, undeclared income, sham transactions, misleading applications or borrowed essential-living money.
No return, saving, valuation, tax outcome or business result is guaranteed.

21. Official research routes

1. BOFiP - French income tax bands - https://bofip.impots.gouv.fr/bofip/2491-PGP.html/identifiant=BOI-IR-LIQ-20-10-20260407
2. French Economy Ministry - Micro-enterprise 2026 - https://www.economie.gouv.fr/entreprises/gerer-sa-micro-entreprise/comment-creer-une-micro-entreprise
3. French Economy Ministry - Micro-enterprise income declarations - https://www.economie.gouv.fr/entreprises/gerer-sa-micro-entreprise/micro-entrepreneurs-comment-declarer-vos-revenus
4. French Economy Ministry - Micro social contributions 2026 - https://www.economie.gouv.fr/entreprises/gerer-sa-micro-entreprise/micro-entreprises-quel-est-le-montant-de-vos-cotisations-sociales
5. impots.gouv.fr - Assurance-vie and PEA - https://www.impots.gouv.fr/particulier/lassurance-vie-et-le-pea-0
6. impots.gouv.fr - Investment income - https://www.impots.gouv.fr/particulier/les-revenus-mobiliers
7. Entreprendre.Service-Public.fr - Business creation - https://entreprendre.service-public.fr/
8. French business formalities portal - https://formalites.entreprises.gouv.fr/